QP CODE: 24900097

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
FIRST SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2024
First Semester
Multi-Disciplinary Course - MG1MDCENG101 - NARRATIVES OF HUMOUR
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)
Duration: 1.5 Hours Maximum Marks: 50
Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply (A), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C), Interest (I), Appreciation (Ap), and Skill (S)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

[Learning Domain] [CO No(s)]

Part A

Multiple Choice Questions. Answer All questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. Where is the oldest recorded joke in the world from? [U] [1, 2]
   b) Ancient Egypt
2. What does the parking-lot attendant say that brings humour to the reality of Walter Mitty's life? [U] [2]
   b) Wrong lane, Mac”
3. How does Smirnov describe his experiences with women? [U] [4]
   b) He’s fought three duels over women
4. Give one instance where *The Proposal* uses physical comedy to make the audience laugh? [K][5]
   b) The movie shows Margaret accidentally setting off a fire alarm.
5. What special event did the Emperor want his new clothes for? [K] [3]
   c) the parade

(5 × 1 = 5)

Part B

Objective Type Questions. Answer any 10 questions. Each question carries 1 mark

6. How does Mitty save the operation from failing due to the faulty machine? [U] [3]
   In "The Secret Life of Walter Mitty," during one of his vivid daydreams, Mitty imagines himself as a brilliant surgeon performing a critical operation. When a machine in the operating room fails, Mitty heroically steps in and fixes it by using a fountain pen to replace a faulty piston. This showcases his imagined competence and resourcefulness, contrasting with his unremarkable real life.
7. What do Mungojerrie and Griddlebone do in the poem "Macavity - The Mystery Cat"? [K] [1]
   They are mentioned as accomplices in Macavity’s mischief and crimes. They help him in his nefarious deeds, adding to his reputation as the "Napoleon of Crime."
8. How does Margaret's interaction with Andrew's Grandmother evoke laughter? [U] [4]
   Margaret's interaction with Andrew's grandmother evokes laughter because Margaret, who is initially stern and uptight, tries to bond with Andrew's grandmother in a humorous way. When she mistakenly misunderstands the grandmother's affectionate comments, it creates awkward and funny moments, especially since Margaret is uncomfortable with her role in the fake engagement.
9. Give two examples of how humour has evolved in the modern era. [U] [1, 2]
   (Marks to be given by assessing the examples given by the students)
10. Who is the author of *The Bear*? [K] [4]
    Anton Chekov

11. Explain how Sai Kiran's comedy challenges the audience to reflect on their own biases. [U] [5]

Sai Kiran's comedy critiques our deep-rooted racial and ethnic biases. (Marks to be given based on the evaluation of critical thinking and interpretative ability demonstrated in the answers)

12. What is Andrew's plan to make Margaret jealous? [K] [4]

Andrew's plan to make Margaret jealous involves him flirting with another woman at the family gathering. He pretends to be interested in a local woman, which makes Margaret uneasy and prompts her to react jealously, despite their fake relationship.

13. What is Stand-up comedy? [U] [5]

Stand-up comedy involves Live performance, Jokes, stories, and humorous observations - Observational humour, satire, and storytelling - Verbal and non-verbal humour

14. What is the profession of Bruce Nolan? [K] [5]

In the movie Bruce Almighty, Bruce Nolan (played by Jim Carrey) is a television field reporter.

15. What specific medical condition does Dr. Renshaw mention in the operating room? [K] [3]

Obstreosis of the ductal tract.

16.What is the setting of the story "The Emperor's New Clothes"? [K] [3]

The setting of the story "The Emperor's New Clothes" is a kingdom, likely in Europe, during a medieval or Renaissance-era time period.

17. What is the tone of the poem "Goodbye Party for Miss Pushpa T.S."? [U] [1]

The tone of the poem "Goodbye Party for Miss Pushpa T.S." by Nissim Ezekiel is formal, sarcastic, and humorous.

(10 × 1 = 10)

Part C

Short Answer Questions (50 Words). Answer any 5 questions. Each question carries 2 marks

18. What qualities of Miss Pushpa T.S. are evident from the speaker's address? [An] [2]

Miss Pushpa T.S. is portrayed as: Kind and helpful, internally and externally sweet, popular among colleagues and, from a reputed family

19. How does Popova initially respond to Smirnov's demand? [U] [4]

Popova initially responds to Smirnov's demand with defiance and anger. When Smirnov arrives at her estate, demanding payment for a debt owed by her late husband, Popova stands her ground, refusing to be intimidated. She criticizes Smirnov's boorish behaviour, telling him that decent people don't speak to women in such a manner. Her strong will and sharp tongue spark a heated argument between the two, setting the stage for the rest of the play.

20. Explain the different types of humour used in the movie *Ratatouille*. [U] [5]

Employs various types of humour - slapstick comedy, wit and sarcasm, satire, and wordplay. The film also uses visual humour, such as expressive character reactions and comedic character designs, to add to the comedic effect.

21. Can stand-up comedy serve as a tool for social change or activism? If so, how? [A] [5]

Stand-up comedy can serve as a tool for social change or activism by raising awareness about social issues, challenging societal norms, and providing a platform for marginalized voices. It inspires critical thinking, sparks conversations, and has the potential to influence public opinion and drive positive change.

22. How does Andrew's personality contrast with Margaret's, and what effect does this have on the film's humour? [An] [5]

Andrew's personality is warm, laid-back, and down-to-earth, contrasting with Margaret's cold, strict, and controlling nature. This contrast creates comedic tension and humour through their witty banter, cultural clashes, and fish-out-of-water situations.

23. Examine the occasions of exaggerated facial expressions by Jim Carrey that amplify

humour in the movie *Bruce Almighty*. [U] [5]

Amplify humour in several key scenes. When Bruce is granted God-like powers and his reactions range from shock to euphoria. His face is a picture of incredulity, adding to the comedic effect. The "parting of the soup" scene, where Bruce's facial expressions convey his surprise and amusement. When Bruce's face contorts in pain and frustration as he struggles to handle the overwhelming prayers from around the world, it adds to the humour, making these scenes some of the most iconic and hilarious in the movie.

24. Why was the Emperor greedy? [U] [3]

The Emperor's greed is shown through his obsession with having the finest clothes to display his wealth and status. His desire for admiration makes him gullible, leading him to believe the swindlers' lie about the invisible fabric.

25. What triggers Walter Mitty's daydreams? [U] [1]

Walter Mitty's daydreams are triggered by moments of boredom, frustration, or when he encounters situations that make him feel inadequate or powerless. These triggers often lead him to escape into vivid fantasies where he imagines himself as a heroic, competent figure.

(5 × 2 = 10)

Part D

Short Essay Questions (150 Words) Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

26. How the character of Steward is used as a medium of humour in *The Bear*? [An] [4]

The character of Luka, the steward, is used to add humour through his exaggerated attempts to mediate the conflict between the main characters, Popova and Smirnov. His comical attempts to calm the situation, his over-the-top suggestions, and his exaggerated concern for Popova's well-being create a sense of absurdity. Luka's interactions, especially when he tries to give advice that only makes things more complicated, contribute to the play's humour and highlight the absurdity of the characters' behaviour.

27. How does the movie *The Proposal* use cultural differences to create humorous situations? [An] [5]

The cultural differences between Margaret, a Canadian, and Andrew, an American, are used to create humorous situations. Margaret's awkward attempts to navigate Andrew’s family traditions, such as her misunderstanding of their customs and her serious, no-nonsense demeanour clashing with their warmth and informality, create comedic moments. Additionally, the clash between Margaret's professional, cold attitude and Andrew’s more laid-back, family-oriented nature leads to funny, uncomfortable situations as they try to convince everyone that their fake engagement is real.

28. Analyze how Sai Kiran’s stand-up satire address social issues like race, gender, and class. [An] [5]

Sai Kiran's stand-up satire addresses social issues like race, gender, and class through witty humor and insightful observations. He critiques racial stereotypes, using comedy to expose biases and promote cultural understanding. His humor also challenges gender norms, questioning sexism and highlighting gender inequality. Additionally, Kiran satirizes social class disparities, using humor to reflect on the absurdities of wealth and privilege, encouraging audiences to critically examine these societal issues.

29. How did the two weavers start their work on the two looms? [K] [3]

The two weavers, who were actually swindlers, pretended to start their work on the two looms, but in reality, they did nothing. They made empty motions as if they were weaving, but there was no actual fabric or thread on the looms.

(2 × 5 = 10)

Part E

Essay Questions (300 Words). Answer any 1 question. Each question carries 15 marks.

30. Would you consider the poem "Goodbye Party for Miss Pushpa T.S." as making gentle fun of the people who cannot speak English properly? Justify. [E] [1]

The poem pokes fun at the Indian accent and the struggles of Indians speaking English, but it does so in a light-hearted and non-malicious way. The tone is playful and humorous, rather than mocking or condescending. The poem "Goodbye Party for Miss Pushpa T.S." by Nissim Ezekiel playfully highlights the struggles of Indians speaking English, particularly in formal settings. The poet gently teases the guests at the party for their mispronunciations, grammatical errors, and awkward expressions.

For instance, lines like "We are all / going to miss you, Pushpa" and "Don't forget to / write to us, please" showcase the stilted language and forced formality. However, the tone remains affectionate and humorous, rather than mocking or critical. The poet's intention is to poke fun at the situation, not to belittle the individuals.

31. Discuss the significance of situational comedy in *The Proposal*. [E] [4]

Situational comedy plays a significant role in creating humour and driving the plot. The film's comedic situations arise from the unlikely pairing of a demanding boss, Margaret, and her dependable assistant, Andrew, who are forced to pretend to be in a romantic relationship. The forced proximity of this fake relationship scenario creates humorous situations as Margaret and Andrew navigate their opposing personalities in close quarters. Additionally, the contrast between Margaret's high-maintenance city life and Andrew's small-town Alaska upbringing provides comedic fodder. The power dynamic between Margaret and Andrew is also flipped, leading to amusing moments as they adapt to their new roles. Furthermore, the situational comedy sets up opportunities for clever dialogue and quick-witted exchanges between the leads. Overall, the situational comedy adds to the film's light-hearted and entertaining tone, making it an enjoyable romantic comedy.

$(1 \times 15 = 15)$